

Jiacheng (Karcen) Zheng

MPhil Student in Applied Economics

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary fields	Econometrics; Causal Inference; Health Economics
Methods	Data Science in Economics; Machine Learning / Natural Language Processing; Input–Output and Network Analysis; Global Value Chains
Other interests	Regional Economics; Poverty; Behavioral Economics; fMRI

EDUCATION

Tianjin University

Sep 2022–Jun 2029 (expected)

MPhil in Applied Economics, Ma Yinchu School of Economics

- Advisor: Asst. Prof. [Shenshen Yang](#)
- Research themes: theoretical econometrics, causal inference, missing data, public health policy
- Honored to be Prof. Yang's first graduate student

Shandong University

Sep 2022–Jun 2026

B.Eng. in Bioengineering, Marine College

- GPA: 86.24/100; rank 5/50 (top 10%); **Outstanding Graduate**
- Dual-degree track in *International Politics & International Economics and Trade*, School of Northeast Asian Studies (2022–2023)
- **Thesis:** *Is More Complexity Always Better? Hepatotoxicity Prediction of Marine Natural Products with in vivo Validation in Danio rerio*; ranked first in the thesis defense group

Dalian University of Technology

Sep 2019–Mar 2021

Chemical Engineering coursework, School of Chemistry

- GPA: 88/100 (top 7.4% of cohort); withdrew in 2021 to retake the Gaokao (National College Entrance Examination)

Selected quantitative coursework: Calculus I (98%), Calculus II (92%), Linear Algebra (90%), Probability and Statistics (88%), University Physics I: Mechanics, Special Relativity, and Optics (98%), University Physics II: Electricity and Magnetism; Introductory Quantum Mechanics (100%).

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles and Conference Papers

1. Khan, J., **Zheng, J.**, Ahmad, M., & Khan, Z. A. "Agglomeration Economies and Inequality: Theory and Evidence from Provincial China." *Journal of Chinese Economic and Business Studies*, **24**(2), 317–340, 2026. [doi:10.1080/14765284.2025.2538328](https://doi.org/10.1080/14765284.2025.2538328)
2. You, P., Chen, A., Feng, Q., Hou, J., **Zheng, J.**, & Chen, H. "Integrative Bioinformatics Prioritizes the TLR4 Axis and Candidate Non-Starch Polysaccharides in Hyperuricemia-Associated Inflammation." *Biology*, **15**, 1150, 2026. [doi:10.3390/biology15141150](https://doi.org/10.3390/biology15141150)
3. Chen, B., Hong, D., Ji, J., **Zheng, J.**, Dong, B., Zhou, J., Wang, K., Dai, J., Wang, X., Chen, W., Zheng, Q., Li, W., Han, S., Guo, Y., & Yang, Y. "InterMT: Multi-Turn Interleaved Preference Alignment with Human Feedback." *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS 2025)*, **Spotlight**. [Project page](#)

Translation and Acknowledged Scholarly Contributions

- Crescenzi, R., & Rodríguez-Pose, A. *Innovation and Regional Growth in the European Union* (Chinese edition; translated by Jianhui Ren et al.). Beijing Economic Management Press, 2024. Contributing translator of

Chapter 3, “Geographical Accessibility and Human Capital Accumulation.” The book received the Third Prize in the “Hundred Works” Project for Outstanding Achievements in Social Science Research, Shanxi Province.

- Khan, J., Li, Y., & Mahsud, Q. J. “Linkages and Structural Changes in the Chinese Financial Sector, 1996–2018: A Network and Input–Output Approach.” *Structural Change and Economic Dynamics*, **70**, 33–44, 2024. [doi:10.1016/j.strueco.2023.12.017](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.strueco.2023.12.017). Acknowledged for data analysis and visualization.
- Li, Y., & Khan, J. *Wind from the East: How Does the Belt and Road Initiative Connect Continents to Unleash Economic Potential?* Peter Lang. [doi:10.3726/b22199](https://doi.org/10.3726/b22199). Contribution acknowledged in the volume.

RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

Sep 2026–Present

Advanced Macroeconomics I (graduate level), Institute of Blue and Green Development, Shandong University

Remote

- Prepare tutorial materials and problem sets; answer student questions on macroeconomic theory and quantitative methods
- Support assignment grading and course administration

Research Assistant

Sep 2025–Present

Ma Yinchu School of Economics & College of Management and Economics (CoME), Tianjin University

On-site

- Conduct research in health economics and financial economics on two projects funded by the National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC)

Research Intern

Feb–May 2025

Big Data Institute, HKUST & Hong Kong Generative AI R&D Center (HKGAI)

Remote

- Conducted data-driven research on preference alignment for multi-turn, multimodal large language models
- Collaborated with Peking University researchers (J. Ji, B. Chen, et al.); the resulting paper was accepted as a *NeurIPS 2025 Spotlight*

Research Assistant

Jul–Aug 2024

The Bartlett School of Sustainable Construction, University College London

Remote

- PI: Prof. Zhifu Mi. Contributed to citation-network analysis of the IPCC Sixth Assessment Report (Working Group II), including reference-database construction and analysis pipelines

Research Assistant

Mar 2023–Mar 2025

Regional and Country-Specific Data Analytics Center, Institute of International Studies, Shandong University

On-site

- PIs: Prof. Yuan Li and Dr. Jamal Khan. Helped build the center’s data infrastructure; supported programming, data visualization, and academic writing
- Worked on input–output analysis, global value chains, and machine learning, deep learning, and NLP methods for data-driven economic modeling

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

31st International Input–Output Association Conference, Malé

2025

Accepted for oral presentation (withdrawn for health reasons): “Linkages and Structural Changes in the Chinese Financial Sector, 1996–2018.”

10th International Workshop on RUSE in China, Peking University

2023

Oral presentation: “Agglomeration Economies and Regional Inequality in Provincial China.”

HONORS, AWARDS, AND DISTINCTIONS

Outstanding Graduate, Shandong University	2026
National Encouragement Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China	2023, 2025
Merit Scholarship (Level III), Shandong University	2023, 2025
Travel Grant, International Input–Output Association (US\$3,000; COMPASS program)	2025
Invited Delegate, PwC Open Day, PwC Jinan	2023
National Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China	2020
Outstanding Student Scholarship (Level II), Dalian University of Technology	2020
Outstanding Youth League Member & Spiritual Civilization Scholarship, DUT	2020
Recommended (exam-exempt) graduate admission offers: Peking University (Institute of New Structural Economics); Xiamen University (WISE); Renmin University of China (School of Applied Economics); Shanghai University of Finance and Economics (School of Economics); Tianjin University (Ma Yinchu School of Economics).	

SELECTED PROJECTS AND OPEN-SOURCE TOOLS

- [Brain Analyzer V3.0](#) (fMRI GUI)
- [ElderAI Survey Platform](#)
- [IPCC References Toolkit](#)
- [Is This Paper Real?](#) (citation authenticity checker) and [BibTeX Reference Validator](#)
- [SDU Thesis L^AT_EX Template \(2026 Edition\)](#)
- [TikZ Atelier](#)
- [Wedding Journal L^AT_EX Template](#)

iTooth — A Digital Platform for Community Oral Health (Team Leader). 13th National University E-commerce “Innovation, Creativity & Entrepreneurship” Challenge, 2022. *Second Prize*, Shandong University round.

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND AFFILIATIONS

Ad hoc referee: *Journal of Chinese Economic and Business Studies*, *Journal of Digital Economy*, *Finance Research Letters*

- Chinese Economic Association UK/Europe (CEA), student member, 2026–Present
- International Input–Output Association (IIOA), member, 2025–2026
- Chinese Society of Optimization, Systems Engineering & Economic Mathematics, member, 2023–2024
- Beijing Society of Image and Graphics, member, 2023–2024

OUTREACH, LEADERSHIP, AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tian Village University Social Practice Project	2026–Present
<i>Community Outreach Lead — volunteer and community engagement</i>	On-site
– Lead after-school tutoring and science outreach for rural primary and middle-school students – Organize community first-aid training (CPR, Heimlich maneuver) and public-health awareness campaigns	
Chinese Economic Association UK/Europe (CEA)	2026–Present
<i>Communications Volunteer</i>	Remote
– Release news updates, compose academic paper interpretations, and maintain the association’s official website	
Structural Change and Economic Dynamics	2023–2025
<i>Volunteer, WeChat Official Account</i>	Remote
– Published news posts and wrote paper interpretations for the journal’s WeChat Official Account	
Teach for China (Bilibili)	2023
<i>Volunteer Teacher</i>	Remote
– Produced popular-science course videos for primary and middle-school students in rural and underserved communities to support educational access and equity	

Golden Education

Summer 2023

*Marketing Management Trainee (mentor: Jihai Zhao)**On-site*

- Planned and executed campus branding campaigns; supported social media operations and expanded campus outreach

Vice President, “Shanghai” Political Observation Club, Shandong University 2024–2025

Director of External Relations, “Shanghai” Political Observation Club, Shandong University 2023–2024

Secretary, Department of Student Rights and Mental Health, School of Northeast Asian Studies, Shandong University 2022–2023

Residence Hall Council Chair, Dalian University of Technology 2019–2021

Deputy Director, New Media, “Yin Ji Guang Ying” New Media Studio, Dalian University of Technology 2019–2021

Deputy Director, Culture and Arts, School of Chemistry, Dalian University of Technology 2019–2020

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Python; R; Stata; MATLAB

Software & tools SPSS; Orange 3; Git / GitHub; L^AT_EX; Microsoft Office; Adobe Creative Suite

Languages Chinese (native); English (IELTS 7.0, 2021)

References available upon request.

Last updated: October 3, 2026